Incident Response Runbook: Payment Service

Severity Levels

SEV1 means the payment service is fully down or more than 20 percent of transactions are failing. SEV2 means degraded performance with latency above 2 seconds at the 95th percentile. SEV3 covers minor issues with no customer impact.

Initial Response (SEV1 and SEV2)

1. Page the on-call engineer through PagerDuty within 5 minutes of detection. 2. Open an incident channel named #inc-YYYYMMDD-short-description in Slack. 3. Assign an Incident Commander. For SEV1, the Incident Commander must be a Staff Engineer or above. 4. Post the first status update on the public status page within 15 minutes.

Rollback

If the incident started within 60 minutes of a deployment, roll back the deployment using the release pipeline: acme-deploy rollback payment-service --env prod. Rollbacks must be approved by the Incident Commander.

Post-Incident Review

A post-incident review must be completed within 5 working days for every SEV1 and SEV2 incident. The review document must include a timeline, root cause, customer impact, and at least three action items with owners.